

Art Generation Kit — Items & UI

Wave 1 + Wave 2 (Press/Garage/stamps)

v1.2 · 12 July 2026

v1.2 · 2026-07-12 (Press ladder revised — steadier mass, no-text, no-Arthur-face; stamp acceptance added) · Attach the Ally key art (app icon image) as *STYLE* reference with every generation. Never as character reference.

Part 1 — Item icons (Wave 1: the four live families, 33 items + 3 generators)

Global item style block (paste with every batch)

Match the attached image's art style: stylized painterly 3D-illustration, rich saturated color, soft cinematic lighting. Render a SINGLE OBJECT as a game item icon: viewed from slightly above (about 15 degrees), centered, filling ~80% of a square canvas, on a fully TRANSPARENT background. No text, no border, no watermark, no drop shadow (the game adds shadows at runtime). Clean, chunky, readable silhouette that stays legible at 96 pixels. Consistent light: soft key from upper-left, gentle warm rim from the right.

Batch A — Forensic Tools (5) · palette: steel grey, teal case-accents, clinical white

File	Item	Art notes
forensic_tools_t01	Cotton Swab	single swab, angled, sterile packet hint
forensic_tools_t02	Evidence Bag	clear zip bag, red EVIDENCE tape strip, something indistinct inside
forensic_tools_t03	Full Forensic Case	small hard case, opened lid showing foam-fit tools
forensic_tools_t04	UV Light	handheld UV torch, violet glow at the lens
forensic_tools_t05	Complete Forensic Kit	premium large case, gleaming instruments, the family's "hero"

Batch B — Fingerprint Evidence (6) · palette: ink navy, white card stock, silver

File	Item	Art notes
fingerprint_evidence_t01	Partial Dusted Print	dusting brush over a half-revealed print on dark surface
fingerprint_evidence_t02	Lifted Print Tape	clear tape strip holding a print, curling slightly
fingerprint_evidence_t03	Fingerprint Card	classic ten-print card, inked prints

File	Item	Art notes
fingerprint_evidence_t04	Labeled Prints	fanned trio of tagged print cards (red/blue/green tabs)
fingerprint_evidence_t05	Digital Scan In Progress	handheld scanner, print mid-scan, cyan scanline
fingerprint_evidence_t06	Database Match	tablet showing matched prints, green MATCH glow

Batch C — Rusty Anchor (10) · palette: amber liquids, brass, warm bar light, dark wood hints

File	Item	Art notes
rusty_anchor_t01	Shot Glass	simple, catch of amber light
rusty_anchor_t02	Short Glass on Ice	tumbler, two cubes, condensation
rusty_anchor_t03	Tall Glass Orange	highball, orange slice on rim
rusty_anchor_t04	Beer Bottle	brown bottle, anchor motif on the label
rusty_anchor_t05	Wine Glass Red	red wine, elegant stem
rusty_anchor_t06	Champagne Flute	rising bubbles, celebratory
rusty_anchor_t07	Wine Bottle & Glasses	bottle + two glasses grouped
rusty_anchor_t08	Anchor Signature Cocktail	showy layered cocktail, tiny anchor pick
rusty_anchor_t09	Whiskey on Ice Premium	crystal tumbler, large sphere ice, deep amber
rusty_anchor_t10	50-Year Scotch	aged bottle, wax seal, faded 50 on the label — the family hero

Batch D — Food Gifts / Corner Diner (12) · palette: warm diner reds/creams, appetizing

File	Item	Art notes
food_gifts_t01	Paper Cup	takeaway cup, plain sleeve
food_gifts_t02	Hot Coffee Cup	steam curl, diner ceramic
food_gifts_t03	Coffee and Donut	classic pairing
food_gifts_t04	Burger Single	stacked, dressed, glossy bun
food_gifts_t05	Burger, Fries	combo grouping

File	Item	Art notes
	& Drink	
food_gifts_t06	Takeaway Caddy	cardboard caddy, multiple items peeking
food_gifts_t07	Pasta Bowl	twirled pasta, herbs
food_gifts_t08	Sushi Bento	tidy bento box
food_gifts_t09	Ice Cream Sundae Luxury	tall glass, layers, cherry
food_gifts_t10	Steak Plate	steak, char lines, sides
food_gifts_t11	Surf and Turf with Wine	steak + lobster tail + wine glass
food_gifts_t12	Lobster Champagne Banquet	whole lobster + champagne — the family hero

Batch E — Generators (3) · each on a subtle base pedestal, more massive/permanent than items

File	Item	Art notes
gen_investigati on_lab	Investigation Lab kit	desktop forensic station: lamp, microscope, files
gen_corner_din er	Corner Diner takeout window	mini diner counter with menu board
gen_junk	Old evidence drawer	worn wooden drawer unit, mixed odds and ends spilling

Tier progression rule across all families: each tier reads visibly “more” than the last — bigger, richer, shinier, more elements — so a player can rank two icons at a glance. **Batch discipline:** generate a family in ONE session with the first approved icon of that family attached as an extra style anchor for the rest. Filename exactly as listed (.png, 1024×1024). Drop finished batches in [OneDrive/AllyQuinn Game/Images/Production 2026 Images/Items/](#) — I take it from there. **Acceptance per icon:** transparent background · silhouette readable at 96px · consistent angle/lighting with its family · no text/shadow.

Part 1b — Wave 2 (Episode 2 dependencies · FINAL, ready to generate · 2026-07-12)

Priority ruling: Press = P0, Garage = P1. Press gates three Ep2 leads (L3 morgue files, L5 episode cutting, L12 the ceremonial Publish) and recurs all season wherever Ally researches, cuts, or publishes. Garage gates one lead (L7, the fused cashbox at Malone’s) and its tier art already exists in [SAS/Item Icons/Item Family - Garage/](#) — import + gap-fill, not regeneration. Timing caveat: if Episode 2 ships in the beta build these are **pre-beta** dependencies; if the launch build is Episode 1 only, the Ep2 timeline (6–8 weeks post-launch) holds.

Batch discipline (same as Wave 1): paste the **Global item style block** (Part 1) with every generation, attach the Ally key art as the STYLE anchor, and after the first Press icon is approved attach it as an extra style anchor for the rest of the family. Files .png, 1024×1024, transparent background. Drop finished batches in [OneDrive/AllyQuinn Game/Images/Production 2026 Images/Items/](#).

Batch F — Press Items (10) · palette: ink black, newsprint cream, brass, worn Gazette red · reads as a story becoming permanent record

Escalation principle (revised 2026-07-12 for steadier mass): the ladder climbs by increasing **object count + physical mass + investigative value** — several tiers PAIR objects so the rise never dips (badge+notebook, recorder+tape, viewer+reel). Distinct silhouette at 96 px per tier.

⚠ **NO TEXT rule (kit-wide) — obey it here:** the earlier draft asked for legible words, handwritten labels, archive dates and headlines. **Remove all of that** — generated text is unreliable and the kit forbids it. Represent “paper/press” with **abstract column strokes, redaction bars, colour tabs, grease-pencil rings, generic photo blocks, and unreadable scribble texture** only. No readable letters anywhere.

⚠ **Do NOT depict Arthur (or any face/person).** Generate t01 from the main style reference only; once approved, attach it as the family anchor for t02–t10. Arthur’s *archive palette and props* — brown card stock, black ink, brass, worn lanyard, red pencil marks — inspire the family; his face never appears on a badge, paper, or folder.

File	Item	Per-tier prompt (append to the global style block · NO readable text)
press_items_t01	Torn Newsprint Clipping	a single light torn scrap of newspaper, abstract column strokes only (no readable words), soft creased edges, newsprint cream and ink black. The rawest, smallest tier.
press_items_t02	Notepad & Pencil	a spiral-bound flip notepad with a pencil laid diagonally across it, unreadable scribble texture on the page. Thicker object + diagonal pencil — clearly more than t01.
press_items_t03	Press Badge & Notebook	a laminated press badge on a worn brass-clipped lanyard resting on a closed leather notebook — a layered pair, hanging lanyard silhouette. Photo area is a blank block, no face.
press_items_t04	Cassette Recorder & Tape	a chunky handheld cassette recorder with a micro-cassette beside it, blank label block, brass screws catching light. Distinct mechanical silhouette, more mass than t03.
press_items_t05	Bulging Clippings Folder	a thick manila folder over-stuffed with papers, colour tabs and protruding clippings held by a paper-clip, one red grease-pencil ring. A visible collection — much more paper.
press_items_t06	Portable Typewriter	a compact vintage portable typewriter, a blank sheet wound in, keys catching warm light, brass

File	Item	Per-tier prompt (append to the global style block · NO readable text)
		return lever. Large, unmistakable machine silhouette.
press_items_t07	Microfiche Viewer & Reel	a boxed microfiche reel seated in/beside a small tabletop viewer, a short film strip pulled out catching light, brass spindle. Taller technical archive equipment.
press_items_t08	Stuffed Morgue File Box	a large corrugated archive box, lid off, several folders standing inside with colour tabs, a redaction bar on one visible sheet. Big box — more mass than the viewer.
press_items_t09	Front-Page Layout Board	a broad flat proof/layout board with column blocks, a generic photo block, red grease-pencil markup, a scalpel and roller resting on it. The widest flat silhouette — the published output.
press_items_t10	The Morgue Cabinet	a tall oak card-catalogue / filing cabinet, one drawer open showing fanned clippings and brass label-holders, a desk-lamp glow on top, worn brass handles — the family hero : biggest, richest, warmest.

Acceptance per icon (same as Wave 1): transparent background · silhouette readable at 96 px · consistent 15° angle + upper-left key with warm right rim · no text baked in beyond the diegetic headline/label hints · each tier visibly “more” than the one below. Generate t01 first, approve, then attach it as the family style anchor for t02-t10.

Batch G — Garage (import pass, no generation unless an icon fails)

Tier art already exists: [SAS/Item Icons/Item Family - Garage/garage_t01-t10](#) (socket wrench → the pimped ride). **Import checklist:** (1) copy the ten PNGs into the item-icon import location; (2) run the GUID/meta pipeline (the Gerald-pattern batch importer) so each gets a stable GUID; (3) confirm each reads at 96 px against the family tier rule; (4) regenerate **only** any tier that fails the silhouette check — no new family, no full regen (ruling 2026-07-12). Garage’s only Ep2 use is L7 (the fused cashbox at Malone’s).

New UI sprites (Ep2 branch stamps) · differ by SYMBOL, not colour alone

Follow the [ui_stamp_public](#) / [ui_stamp_protected](#) pattern (distressed rubber-stamp ring, text overlaid at runtime, transparent background, readable at mobile size). Attach the Ally key art as style anchor.

File	Prompt (append to the item style block, but render as a FLAT UI stamp, not a 3D object)
ui_stamp_shielded	a distressed shield-shaped (or octagonal) rubber-stamp border in steel blue, ink-worn and uneven, with a small clean SHIELD silhouette centered inside; empty band top and bottom for runtime text (“WITNESS SHIELDED”). No baked text. Transparent background.

File	Prompt (append to the item style block, but render as a FLAT UI stamp, not a 3D object)
ui_stamp_daylight	a distressed circular sunburst ring in warm amber-gold, with a small SUN-with-rays silhouette centered inside; empty band for runtime text (“TRUTH IN DAYLIGHT”). No baked text. Transparent background.

Stamp acceptance (both): readable at **48 and 64 px**; the central symbol survives in **greyscale** (colour is secondary); a clear **text-safe band** for the runtime label; the distress texture must **not** erase the symbol; and the two use **materially different outer silhouettes** — a **shield-shaped / octagonal** border for WITNESS SHIELDED, a **circular sunburst** border for TRUTH IN DAYLIGHT — so they differ by shape as well as symbol.

Accessibility rule: the pair must be distinguishable for a colour-blind player — the **shield vs. sun-rays symbols** carry the distinction, blue/amber is secondary. Both must read at ~120 px on a case-summary card. (Ep1’s [ui_stamp_public/ui_stamp_protected](#) are still outstanding too — see the readiness audit; the same symbol-not-colour rule applies if they get a symbol pass.)

Part 2 — UI sprites (small batch, big effect)

Same style reference. All on transparent background unless noted.

File	What	Notes
ui_icon_energy	Energy bolt	matches the existing generator badge language, richer render
ui_icon_casecas h	CaseCash	banded stack of worn notes, noir-green
ui_icon_ingot	Platinum Ingots	three stacked silver-white ingots, cool sheen
ui_icon_settings	Settings gear	simple, chunky
ui_panel_9slice	Popup panel	rounded rect, deep navy (#0A1220) body, subtle lighter border, uniform corners — MUST have symmetric corners for 9-slicing; flat center
ui_button_9slice	Button	rounded pill, teal fill, subtle top highlight; symmetric corners
ui_stamp_public	“PUBLIC TRUTH” stamp	distressed red rubber-stamp ring, no text needed (text is overlaid)
ui_stamp_protected	“PROTECTED TRUTH” stamp	same, in steel blue
bg_rivermouth_night	Scene background	P0 — the real Ep1 backdrop (replaces the purple-viaduct stand-in). Portrait, ≥1284×2778: stylized Havenbay/Rivermouth riverside street at night — distant iron swing-bridge silhouette over dark water, amber sodium street-lamps, wet

File	What	Notes
		cobbles, low river fog, deep navy sky (#0A1220). Keep the central 60% low-detail/darker — the board covers it; put interest in the top third (sky/bridge) and bottom third (street/river). No people, vehicles, text. Full generation prompt issued to Stephen 2026-07-12.

HUD architecture ruling (2026-07-12): the top bar is **component-built, not a background image**. The old `HUDImage` placeholder (`HUD3_Transparent_0`, 920×238, a big baked panel that forced the ~320 px oversized HUD) is **retired** — do not replace it with another background image. The compact Gossip-Harbor-style bar is assembled in code from `ui_meter_pill_9s` (currency pills), `ui_top_avatar_frame` (portrait), the `ui_top_energy/soft/premium` icons, and `ui_icon_settings` (gear, replacing the “MENU” text button). This is Claude’s #2 UI pass (HUD-shrink + board-density), not an art-generation task.

If any 9-slice sprite generates poorly (uneven corners), tell me and I build it programmatically instead — items and the background are where generation genuinely wins.